

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel and SIEM Engineer | KQL | Detection Engineering | Multi-Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of deep, hands-on experience engineering and optimising Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) solutions across large hybrid and multi-cloud environments. I specialise in enterprise-wide log onboarding, SIEM content development, and the design and tuning of detection analytics using Kusto Query Language (KQL). I have practical experience deploying and configuring data connectors, building custom detection rules and analytical workbooks, and partnering with incident response (IR) teams to tune detection logic against real threat actor activity. My background spans CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation, and PowerShell scripting for security task automation. I am experienced in normalising and optimising log telemetry at scale, maintaining data quality and cost control across ingestion pipelines, and delivering measurable improvements to detection fidelity for organisations with complex, multi-platform estates.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platform Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel - enterprise log onboarding, data connector deployment (built-in and custom), Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics, workbook development, data normalisation using the Advanced Security Information Model (ASIM), cost and ingestion optimisation
- **KQL and Detection Content Development:** scheduled and near-real-time analytics; custom detection rules; alert logic tuning against live threat actor behaviours; false-positive reduction
- **Log Ingestion and Telemetry:** multi-cloud and hybrid environment log onboarding (Azure, Microsoft 365, on-premises); log parsing, normalisation, and optimisation; ingestion volume control; Azure Monitor and Log Analytics Workspace administration
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps); SOAR workflow development; automated alert triage and enrichment; PowerShell scripting for security operations automation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM log integration and event forwarding into Sentinel
- **Cloud Security:** Azure Active Directory (AD) / Microsoft Entra ID; Conditional Access; Microsoft Defender for Cloud; Microsoft 365 security stack; hybrid cloud visibility
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Insight; NIST SP 800-61; MITRE ATT&CK framework; detection refinement based on live IR findings
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Conditional Access; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); ISO 27001; CIS Controls; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Own the enterprise-wide Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment for an 8,000-user hybrid environment, managing log onboarding from Microsoft 365, Azure Active Directory (AD) / Entra ID, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and on-premises infrastructure sources.
- Design, deploy, and maintain Sentinel data connectors, including custom connectors for bespoke data sources, ensuring comprehensive log coverage across hybrid and cloud-based systems.

- Author and continuously tune KQL-based scheduled analytics and near-real-time detection rules, aligning detection logic directly to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and refining rules based on IR team findings from live incidents.
- Manage log telemetry normalisation and ingestion optimisation across the Log Analytics Workspace, applying data transformation rules and filtering to control ingestion costs while maintaining detection coverage.
- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks (Logic Apps) to automate alert enrichment, IOC lookups, and first-response actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume alert categories.
- Partner with the incident response (IR) team on active security incidents, feeding detection gaps identified during live investigations back into Sentinel rule development and tuning cycles.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover), integrating CrowdStrike telemetry into Sentinel via data connector and maintaining bidirectional alert correlation between platforms.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Insight, using KQL and Falcon Query Language (FQL) to identify novel attacker techniques and undetected threats within the environment.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), maintaining alert policies and coordinating with Sentinel for unified cross-platform detection.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, and Single Sign-On (SSO) policies contributing to the overall identity security posture monitored through Sentinel.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security

March 2022 - March 2025

- Developed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection analytics, including scheduled analytics rules, hunting queries, and watchlists, tuning detections against real threat intelligence and IR feedback to reduce false-positive rates.
- Managed log ingestion and connector health across Microsoft Sentinel, troubleshooting data source gaps and onboarding new log sources including Mimecast, CrowdStrike, and on-premises Active Directory (AD) infrastructure.
- Built SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate repetitive triage tasks, including automated IOC enrichment via threat intelligence feeds and automated response actions for high-confidence alert types.
- Performed proactive threat hunting using KQL within Sentinel and CrowdStrike Insight, mapping discovered adversary behaviours to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and developing new detection rules from hunting findings.
- Supported incident response activities, using Sentinel investigation graphs and entity behaviour analytics (UEBA) to trace lateral movement, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration across the hybrid estate.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon deployment and policy configuration, aligning EDR telemetry ingestion with Sentinel for unified cross-platform visibility.
- Administered Entra ID / Azure AD Conditional Access policies and MFA configurations, contributing identity-layer telemetry to Sentinel for anomalous sign-in detection.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 compliance activities, maintaining SIEM evidence and security control documentation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security monitoring and log management controls across cloud and hybrid SaaS/FinTech infrastructure, supporting early-stage SIEM log collection and event correlation.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (AD) identity controls, enforcing MFA and RBAC across internal and customer-facing platforms.
- Conducted security quality assurance and compliance reviews of infrastructure changes in a structured, process-driven environment aligned to regulatory requirements.
- Monitored infrastructure security posture, applied patch management processes, and supported incident escalation and response procedures.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Onboarded and normalised log telemetry from over 15 data sources into Microsoft Sentinel, achieving full hybrid environment visibility across endpoints, identity, email, cloud services, and on-premises infrastructure.
- Authored and tuned over 40 KQL-based Sentinel detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing false-positive alert rates by refining detection logic against live threat intelligence and IR-validated adversary behaviours.
- Built and deployed SOAR playbooks automating IOC enrichment, first-response containment actions, and analyst notifications, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common alert types by over 60 percent.
- Integrated CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel, enabling unified cross-platform threat detection and correlation across the full endpoint and identity estate.
- Delivered proactive threat hunting programmes using KQL and CrowdStrike Insight, identifying and remediating previously undetected compromise attempts across the university estate.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, with Sentinel providing the audit-ready evidence base for detection and monitoring controls.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)